



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

BALANCING ACT

West Hollywood resident Ryan Christen holds his 18-month-old son, Orlo, atop his shoulder while voting Tuesday at Beverly Hills City Hall. Scan this code to read our coverage at latimes.com and in our eNewspaper, where subscribers get an exclusive “LATEXtra.”



TRUMP SIGNS ORDER TO VET NEW AI

Companies are asked to allow government agencies to evaluate models before release.

By Ana Ceballos, Nilesh Christopher and Justine McDaniel

WASHINGTON — President Trump signed an executive order Tuesday directing the federal government to establish a voluntary early review process for the country’s most advanced artificial intelligence models, following a months-long internal battle over how aggressively Washington should move to regulate the fast-growing technology.

Under the order, companies are asked to allow government agencies, including the National Security Agency and representatives of the Defense Department, to evaluate cutting-edge models up to 30 days before they are released to the public. The order stops short of mandating participation and explicitly bars the creation of any new licensing or permitting for AI models.

“The main question is whether this is the start of a continued government clampdown and response to continued AI capabilities, or whether this is a one-off, limited, and truly voluntary act,” said James Sanders, research associate at the Center for a New American Security, a Washington, D.C., think tank.

“It’s unclear how voluntary this will stay and how voluntary it will be in practice as the AI labs try to maintain good relationships with the U.S. government,” he said.

The order represents a reversal for Trump, less than two weeks after he scuttled a version of the policy that gave the government a 90-day review period — and, more broadly, for an administration that came to power promising to strip away AI guardrails, a posture that slowly created fractures within the GOP.

In the executive order, Trump appeared to frame a need to foster AI technologies while taking into account national security. “As these capabilities evolve, my Administration will continue to work closely with industry to ensure that the best and most secure technology is deployed rapidly to confront any and all threats to our country,” he said in [See AI, A8]

‘Be patient’: Painstaking count may take time

Experts cite high volume, mail-ins, tightness of races

By Grace Toohey

It took three weeks to call a particularly competitive 2022 U.S. House race in California’s Central Valley, the outcome coming down to a couple of hundred votes.

Two years later, state Sen. Laura Richardson waited 17 days to be announced victor of a hotly contested race in South Los Angeles.

That same year, an unprecedented second-place tie in Northern California forced a recount that took almost two months to sort

out.

California — and particularly Los Angeles County — is notorious for slow election counts. But Tuesday’s primary could test the patience of even the most-knowing political junkies as some of the highest-profile races, including California governor and L.A. mayor, remain tight.

“We’re trying to keep people calm,” said Tracy Hernandez, chief executive of New California Coalition, a nonpartisan group that works on policy solutions. “Expect not to know.”

Experts who spoke to

The Times say results from some of the most publicized and close contests probably would not be clear Tuesday night, though many races could be called by then. Most estimated that the top two candidates for California governor and L.A. mayor were unlikely to be confirmed until Wednesday or Thursday, though there are several factors that could stretch that process out even longer.

Primaries in California identify the top two vote-getters in each race — regardless of party preference — [See Count, A6]

Voter discontent aimed at status quo in blue state

Consensus eludes Democrats on who should lead California, L.A. into the future.

By Jenny Jarvie

As primary voters head to the polls Tuesday to determine which candidates will face off in November to become California’s governor and Los Angeles’ mayor, both races are wide open, with a new crop of candidates challenging the Democratic status quo.

For Democrats, little clear consensus has emerged so far on who should lead the city and state into the future.

In California’s crowded gubernatorial race, Democrats have struggled in recent months to settle on a candidate to succeed term-limited Gov. Gavin Newsom.

After former Rep. Eric Swalwell suspended his campaign in April amid allegations of sexual misconduct, Xavier Becerra, a former Biden Cabinet member, inched ahead by positioning himself as the safe, experienced Democratic candidate. Another Democrat,

billionaire climate activist Tom Steyer, and Republican Steve Hilton, a former Fox News commentator, trail close behind.

In L.A., experience seems to be as much a liability as an advantage.

Mayor Karen Bass finds herself in the extraordinary position, as an incumbent, of fighting to make the runoff as she is assailed from the left and the right. The latest UC Berkeley-L.A. Times poll shows Bass leading with just 26% of the vote, 1 percentage point ahead of City Councilmember Nithya Raman, a wonkish democratic socialist, and 4 points ahead of Republican Spencer Pratt, a former reality TV star.

“There’s a clear sense of frustration with the Democratic Party,” said Sara Sadhwani, a professor of politics at Pomona College. The reason a wave of conservative outsiders such as Pratt and Hilton are doing so well in such a solidly liberal city and state, Sadhwani said, is that they’re more willing to spell out the challenges that L.A. and California face.

“Democrats tend to be very concerned about not upsetting one coalition or another, so it’s politics as [See Status quo, A7]



KAYLA BARTKOWSKI Los Angeles Times

REPUBLICANS turned out at higher rates in early voting, while Democrats seemed to be holding off.

June looms large for Supreme Court

Decisions are coming on citizenship, gun rights and transgender athletes before recess.

By David G. Savage

WASHINGTON — Now in the final month of its yearly term, the Supreme Court is facing decisions on birthright citizenship, gun rights, transgender athletes and President Trump’s power over independent agencies.

Unlike in years past, the term’s most significant rulings were not left for the last

week in June.

The court dealt Trump a major defeat in February by striking down his sweeping worldwide tariffs. The president is likely to suffer a second defeat when the justices reject his plan to revise the citizenship laws via an executive order.

Republicans won when the court struck down a Louisiana congressional district that favored a Black Democrat.

That decision has already shifted several congressional districts toward the GOP, but its greatest impact will be seen in 2028 and 2030.

Republicans are likely to

prevail in two other pending cases.

One would free party committees to raise and spend more money to support their candidates. A second would change state laws to bar counting of mail ballots that arrive after election day.

The justices have 26 cases waiting to be decided before they go on a summer recess. Here are the major cases due for decision:

Birth citizenship opposed by Trump

Does the 14th Amendment of 1868 mean what it says about who is a citizen?

It declares: “All persons born or naturalized in the United States and subject to the jurisdiction thereof are citizens of the United States.”

The Supreme Court upheld that understanding in 1898, ruling that Wong Kim Ark, who was born to Chinese parents in San Francisco, was a U.S. citizen at birth. Congress adopted birthright citizenship in the Immigration and Nationality Acts of 1940 and 1952.

But on his first day back in the White House, Trump issued an executive order to deny citizenship to the newborns of parents who are in [See Court, A8]

Post-fire rent hike ban has expired

L.A. County rule to protect survivors of 2025 blazes falls short of support in vote.

By Roger Vincent

A rule intended to prevent rent gouging in the wake of the Eaton and Palisades fires has lapsed in Los Angeles County, possibly exposing some renters to hikes.

The executive order that blocked rent increases was issued by Gov. Gavin Newsom amid the devastating wildfires last year. Under the order, landlords couldn’t increase rents by more than 10% above their prefire levels.

The rule, which was supposed to be temporary and was repeatedly extended, ended Friday after a vote to extend it again failed to garner enough votes. Supervisor Lindsey Horvath, whose district includes Pacific Palisades, sounded the alarm in a motion to extend price protections that failed to pass at the Board of Supervisors’ May 19 meeting.

“These price gouging protections continue to be necessary as construction and rebuilding continue, and as thousands of people remain displaced,” the motion said. “Families which signed short-term leases could face drastic price increases of 50% or more without further price gouging protection.”

Los Angeles County is [See Ban, A11]

Why is control of JPL now up for grabs?

Its first-ever contested bid isn’t unwelcome, but some worry about bias in federal process.

By Corinne Purtill

Weeks after Trump administration officials announced that management of NASA’s Jet Propulsion Laboratory would open to competitive bidding for the first time, questions remain as to why Caltech could lose control of the lab its researchers founded in 1936.

On one hand, observers note, high-profile delays and cost overruns on significant recent JPL projects earned sharp criticism from NASA even before the 2024 presidential election.

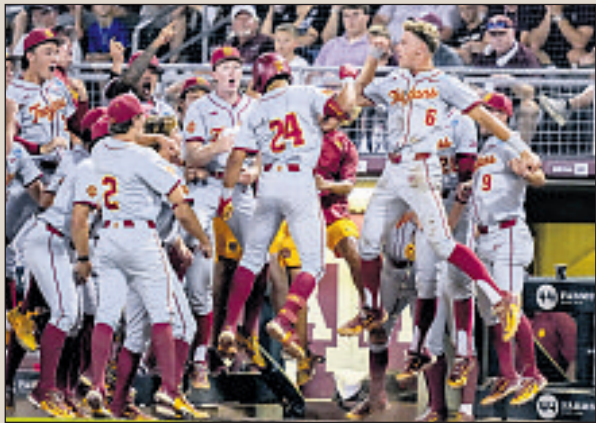
On the other, the second Trump administration’s record of squeezing scientific funding and attacking institutions in Democratic-

led states make it difficult to consider any action as separate from the charged political atmosphere, analysts say.

“My first instinct is that this [competition] isn’t necessarily a bad thing. It’s not written in stone that Caltech must run JPL, and it wouldn’t be the worst thing to have some competition for running the place,” said Casey Dreier, chief of space policy at the nonprofit Planetary Society.

“That said, that requires this contract evaluation to be fair and unbiased, and this administration has no credibility in such things,” he added. “The responsibility is on NASA to earn the trust and ensure such an evaluation is open and free from political meddling. That’s almost impossible.”

JPL became part of NASA when the space agency was formed in 1958, and Caltech has been [See JPL, A14]



MIKALA COMPTON Austin American-Statesman

USC WINS, ADVANCES

Augie Lopez (24) revels with his teammates after he hit a three-run home run in USC’s 7-1 regional-clinching victory. **SPORTS, B10**

Rep. Gomez admits ‘mistakes’

The L.A. congressman says he hurt his family but broke no ethics rules. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Mindy Kaling’s writing is NSF

Her new TV comedy has fun with being an NYC 20-something. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

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Weather
Turning sunny.
L.A. Basin: 78/59. **B6**

Markets **A11**

Opinion Voices **A12**